Before ERAS opens

Anchor dates from the AAMC's 2027 ERAS timeline and the NRMP's 2027 Main Residency Match calendar. Dates shift a little each year; confirm the current ones before you plan around them.

Early clinical years

- [ ] Keep a running list of patients, cases and projects that stuck with you
- [ ] Note attendings and residents who saw your work up close
- [ ] Try to explore the specialties you're curious about
- [ ] Ask your school when away rotations get planned

Winter and spring before you apply

- [ ] Pick a specialty (or a main one plus a backup)
- [ ] Ask for letters: CV, talking points, early deadline
- [ ] Check your specialty's letter and exam expectations
- [ ] Talk to an advisor and residents in that field
- [ ] Draft your personal statement

June: ERAS opens (June 4, 2026 for ERAS 2027)

- [ ] Start your MyERAS application early
- [ ] Write up experiences while details are fresh
- [ ] Look up your specialty's program signal rules
- [ ] Build a first program list and budget

Your letter writers

- [ ] Writer 1: asked / reminded / uploaded
- [ ] Writer 2: asked / reminded / uploaded
- [ ] Writer 3: asked / reminded / uploaded
- [ ] Thank-you notes sent

From submit to Match Day

September: submit

- [ ] Submit on the first day if you can (Sept 2, 2026)
- [ ] Budget fees: $11/program for 1-30, $30 each after, per specialty
- [ ] Register for the NRMP Match (opened Sept 15, 2026)
- [ ] Programs start reviewing + MSPE (Sept 23, 2026)

October to January: interviews

- [ ] Log every invite and reply quickly
- [ ] Test camera, light and sound for virtual days
- [ ] Write notes right after each interview
- [ ] NRMP standard registration deadline (Jan 29, 2027)

February to March: rank and Match

- [ ] Ranking opens (Feb 1, 2027)
- [ ] Rank in the order you truly prefer
- [ ] Certify your rank list early (deadline Mar 3, 2027, 9 p.m. ET)
- [ ] Match Week starts (Mar 15, 2027)
- [ ] Match Day! (Mar 19, 2027, 12 p.m. ET)

After Match Day

- [ ] Celebrate (seriously!)
- [ ] Thank your letter writers and mentors
- [ ] Watch for your program's onboarding and contract emails
- [ ] Start the licensing paperwork your program asks for